The Sunken Temple



An example adventure for typesetters

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Chapter 1: The Village of Saltmere

The tide is out, and the whole village smells of salt and tar. Nets hang drying between the houses, and a bell clangs somewhere out on the flats, though there is no wind to ring it.

The buildings around are dilapidated and empty, the only warmth coming from a low-slung building to the west, balanced on stilts which keep it out of the muddy water. The sign outside declares itself to be "The Drowned Bell".

altmere is a fishing village of forty-odd families, built on stilts above the mudflats where the river meets the sea. Its people are friendly enough to strangers who pay in coin, and wary of anyone who asks about the old temple.

1: The Drowned Bell

The village's only tavern stands at the end of the longest jetty. Its keeper, Morwen Tull, serves fish stew and weak ale, and knows everyone's business.

Hidden text
Morwen's brother vanished into the temple last spring. She will offer the party 50 gold pieces to find out what happened to him. His body is found inside the temple, killed by the Typesetter.

Normal text
Morwen is happy to talk about the temple, if the party buys a round.

2: The Dock

A grandiose name for the portion of the jetty facing out to sea, it is here that the old sea dogs gather before heading off to the pub for the evening, and trade the latest catch amongst themselves.

Determine what the fishermen have caught using the following table:

d4	Fish	Result
1	Nothing	The fishermen are angry. If the players enter the inn, 5 (1d6+2) commoners will attempt to pick a fight with them.
2	Minnows	The mood in the inn is more sombre than usual.
3	Cod	The fishermen are pleased. They buy all the players a round.
4	Tuna	A raucous night is had by all. Any players who partake in the celebrations must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or become *poisoned* for one hour, but are immune to fear until the end of their next long rest.

3: The Chapel

A small chapel dedicated to the god Knonald Duth, run by the local priest, who is found within the The Drowned Bell (1) whenever not giving sermons.

3A: The Hidden Vestry

Behind a large portrait of Knonald is a door which leads to a dusty old room, where the priests would once have changed into ceremonial robes.

3B: The Basement

In the centre of this cramped space is a book which has been bound to a pedestal and chained shut (DC 15 to unlock or force open). An individual who reads the book becomes *incapacitated* until shaken awake by another creature.

The book was written with Knonald's Quill.

4: The Sunken Temple

A forbidden temple which has fallen into disrepair and slipped beneath the waves. The townsfolk avoid it.

As the doors to the temple crack open, your eyes become fixed on the waves of beautiful writing which cover every surface of the temple's walls.

It takes you a minute before you spot the emaciated bodies lining the walls, those unlucky enough to have become entranced by the writing, and stayed there until they starved to death, or worse, were killed by the hulking monster that now approaches you from the bowels of the temple...

The Typesetter approaches! Roll initiative!

Appendix A: Creatures

The Typesetter

Medium Undead, Chaotic evil

AC	15	**Speed**	30ft
HP	78 (12d8+24)	**Initiative**	+2

	STR (12)	DEX (15)	CON (14)	INT (18)	WIS (14)	CHA (12)
MOD	+1	+2	+2	+4	+2	+1
SAVE	+4			+7		

Skills History (+10), Perception (+5), Arcana (+7)
Senses passive Perception 15
Languages Common, Draconic, LaTeX
Challenge 6 (2200xp, proficiency: +3)

Legendary Resistance (2/day). When The Typesetter fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Drowned Spellcasting. The Typesetter may cast the following spells without requiring components. They have +7 to hit, save DC 15

At will: *faulty preamble, thunderclap*
2/day: *fireball*
3rd level (2 slots): *compile document*

Actions

Inkblade. *Melee (10ft) or Ranged (20/60ft):* +7 to hit. *On Hit:* 8 (1d8+4) necrotic damage.

Legendary Actions (2 uses)

Immediately after another creature's turn, The Typesetter can expend a Legendary Action to take one of the following actions. Expended actions are regained at the start of each of its turns.

Rapid Edit. The Typesetter makes an Inkblade attack, then moves up to 30 feet.

Mythic Monster

Second Phase. When reduced to 0HP, The Typesetter recovers all hit points and removes all negative status effects.

When the mythic trait activates, read the following aloud:

> Just as the Typesetter falls, a voice rings out: *"but will it compile on Overleaf?"* The ink on the walls begins to move...

When the mythic trait is activated, The Typesetter gains the following traits and Legendary Actions.

Online Woes. Choose a point within 10 feet of the Typesetter. All creatures within a 60ft sphere must make a DC 15 Intelligence save.

On Failure: 22 (4d10) psychic damage, and is stunned until the end of its next turn

On Success: half damage, and is not stunned

Powerful Dragon Format

Tiny Dragon, Lawful neutral

AC	13	**Speed**	10ft, fly 30ft
HP	11 (2d8+2)	**Initiative**	+3

	STR (5)	DEX (16)	CON (12)	INT (16)	WIS (12)	CHA (15)
MOD	-3	+3	+1	+3	+1	+2
SAVE				+5	+3	

Senses passive Perception 11
Languages Draconic, LaTeX
Challenge 1/8 (10xp, proficiency: +2)

Portable. The PDF is unaffected by its surroundings, ignoring difficult terrain and strong winds.

Actions

Claw. *Melee (5ft):* +5 to hit. *On Hit:* 2 (1d4) slashing damage plus 3 (1d6) fire damage.

Characters who search the scriptorium after the Typesetter's defeat may roll once on the table below.

The Typesetter's Hoard

d6	Loot
1	A case of lead type, worth 10 (3d6) gold pieces to any printer.
2	A bottle of ink that never dries, and never fades.
3	A ream of vellum, each sheet watermarked with a sea serpent.
4	A brass composing stick, engraved with the name *Knonald*.
5	A sealed letter from Morwen's brother, addressed to his sister.
6	*Knonald's Quill*, if the Typesetter did not use it in the fight.

Appendix B: Treasure & Magic

The following items can be found in the temple, and the Typesetter casts the spells below.

Magic Items

Knonald's Quill

Rare Wondrous item. Requires attunement by a creature with an Intelligence of 13 or higher

As an action, you may use this quill to write on any surface. The symbols you write are so beautifully typeset that a creature which reads them must succeed on a DC 13 Intelligence saving throw or be charmed by you, as if by the *charm person* spell.

Spells

Compile Document

3rd level Conjuration

Casting time: 1 action
Area of Effect: 30-foot cube (60 feet)
Components: VS
Duration: Instantaneous

Roll 2 (1d4). That many documents within the area are converted into a *Powerful Dragon Format*, which acts on its own initiative and regards you as an ally. For each dragon created in this way, you regain 5 hit points.

At higher levels. The hit points restored by each dragon increase by 5 for every spell level above 3rd used to cast this spell.

Faulty Preamble

Evocation Cantrip

Casting time: 1 action
Range: Touch
Components: VSM
Duration: Until dispelled

You corrupt a document that you touch. When this document is next affected by *compile document*, it does not become a Powerful Dragon Format. Instead, it deals 5 (1d10) psychic damage to the creature attempting the compilation.

This cantrip improves with your character level:

Level	1st	5th	11th	17th
Damage	1d10	2d10	3d10	4d10